Recycling Service Pilot Implementation

This document sets out how the recycling service pilot will be implemented across the participating collection sites, from mobilisation through review. It defines the operating scope, the duties of the delivery team, the evidence that will be gathered and the questions the review must answer. The pilot runs for 12 weeks and is treated as a learning exercise: observations are recorded separately from any causal claims about household behaviour or material recovery.

Pilot Purpose and Operating Scope

The pilot tests whether a revised collection and sorting arrangement can be delivered reliably at the participating sites within the agreed service window. Scope covers kerbside set-out, transfer to the sorting point, contamination checks and resident communication. Activities outside this scope, including permanent fleet procurement and long-term contract changes, are excluded and will be considered only after the review reports its findings to the sponsoring committee.

Service Model and Collection Routes

The service model uses a fixed weekly route pattern with two collection passes per site and a shared transfer point. Route sequencing was chosen to keep vehicle dwell time short and to allow sorting staff to receive material in consistent batches. Route supervisors record arrival and departure times at each stop so that the review can compare planned and actual service delivery without attributing differences to any single cause.

Site Readiness and Equipment

Each site must be confirmed ready before collections begin. Readiness covers bin placement, signage, access for collection vehicles, staff briefing and a dry sorting area. Site leads sign a readiness checklist and report exceptions to the pilot coordinator, who decides whether a site starts on schedule or joins in a later wave. Equipment shortfalls are logged and resolved before the first collection pass.

Bin Allocation and Resident Communication

Bin allocation follows household size bands agreed with site leads, and every household receives a short printed guide in plain language. Communication covers set-out times, accepted materials and what happens when a bin is rejected. Residents can raise questions through a local phone line, with responses targeted within 2 working days. Messages are kept consistent across sites so that the review can compare experiences fairly.

Contamination Checks at Set-Out

Collection crews carry out a visual contamination check at set-out and tag bins that contain clearly non-accepted material. Tagged bins are recorded with a reason code and left for the household to correct before the next pass. Crews do not open sealed bags. The check is a service quality measure, not an enforcement action, and households receive a follow-up note explaining the correction needed.

Supporting records are presented in Figure 1.



Figure 1: Contamination tag reason codes

Sorting Point Intake Records

The sorting point keeps an intake record for every batch, noting arrival time, source site, estimated weight band and visible contamination. Records are entered on the same day and cross-checked by a second staff member. Where a batch is held back for inspection, the reason is written on the record. These entries form the main evidence base for the review and are retained for the full pilot period.

Supporting records are presented in Table 1.

Entry	Detail	Owner	Retention
Arrival time	Clock time	Sorting staff	Pilot
Source site	Site code	Sorting staff	Pilot
Weight band	Estimated	Sorting staff	Pilot
Hold reason	Written note	Reviewer	Pilot

Table 1: Sorting point intake record contents

Temporary Site Adjustments

Site leads may request temporary adjustments, such as a moved collection point

or an extra bin, when access or weather conditions require it. Requests are submitted in writing and approved by the pilot coordinator within 5 working days. Approved adjustments are logged with the date, reason and expected duration so that the review can distinguish planned service design from short-term operational fixes.

Route Contingency Arrangements

When a route cannot be completed, the supervisor activates a contingency plan that prioritises households missed on the previous pass and defers non-urgent transfers. Affected residents are notified the same day through the local phone line and printed notice where needed. Each activation is recorded with the trigger, the stops affected and the recovery date, allowing the review to assess how often contingency arrangements were needed.

Site Readiness Evidence and Checks

Readiness evidence is collected through signed checklists, photographs of bin placement and brief notes from site briefings. The coordinator samples completed checklists to confirm that entries are consistent and that exceptions were resolved. Evidence is filed by site and week, so that any later question about a site's starting condition can be answered from the record rather than from recollection.

Monitoring, Records and Reporting

Monitoring combines route logs, sorting point intake records and resident contact notes. The pilot coordinator compiles a short weekly summary for the delivery team and a fuller report at the end of the pilot. Records are kept in a single shared register with clear ownership, and any gap is flagged at the next weekly meeting so that it can be corrected while the relevant staff are still available.

Supporting records are presented in Figure 2.

Supporting records are presented in Table 2.



Figure 2: Weekly monitoring register fields and record owners

Product	Audience	Timing	Owner
Weekly summary	Delivery team	Weekly	Coordinator
Checkpoint note	Committee	Mid-pilot	Coordinator
Final report	Committee	End	Review team
Register extract	Auditors	On request	Coordinator

Table 2: Reporting products and their audiences

Sampling and Observation Method

Observation uses a structured sampling approach across the participating sites, with checks spread over the pilot period rather than concentrated in one week. Observers follow a written checklist and record what they see without inferring household intent. Simulated observations are labelled as such in the register, and the review team is instructed not to treat observed associations as evidence of cause and effect.

Data Handling and Quality Assurance

Data handling follows a simple rule: one entry, one owner, one date. The register is reviewed weekly for missing fields, duplicate batch records and inconsistent reason codes. A second reviewer checks a sample of entries against paper forms. Corrections are made by annotation rather than deletion, so that the review can see what changed and why, and the audit trail remains intact.

Supporting records are presented in Table 3.

Check	Method	Reviewer	Action
Missing field	Weekly scan	Coordinator	Follow-up
Duplicate entry	Cross-check	Second reviewer	Annotate
Code mismatch	Sample	Second reviewer	Correct
Paper match	Sample	Reviewer	Annotate

Table 3: Quality assurance checks on register entries

Weekly Summary and Escalation

Each week the coordinator issues a short summary covering collections completed, tagged bins, held batches and open resident questions. Issues that affect safety or service continuity are escalated to the sponsoring committee

immediately rather than waiting for the weekly cycle. The summary is deliberately brief so that the delivery team reads it, and detailed figures remain in the register for the final review.

Observation Log and Sample Coverage

The observation log records what was seen at each check, the time, the site and the observer. Coverage is tracked against the planned sample so that under-observed periods are visible early. The table below summarises the planned observation schedule and the type of evidence each check produces, distinguishing recorded observations from later interpretation by the review team.

Supporting records are presented in Table 4.

Check	Timing	Evidence	Use
Set-out review	Morning	Photo note	Coverage
Bin tagging	Each pass	Reason code	Quality
Batch intake	Arrival	Intake record	Traceability
Resident call	As raised	Contact note	Concerns

Table 4: Planned observation checks and evidence produced

Record Gaps and Follow-Up Actions

When a record is missing, the coordinator raises a follow-up action with a named owner and a due date. Actions are closed only when the missing entry is restored or the gap is explained in writing. Recurring gaps are discussed at the weekly meeting, since they often point to a form design problem or an unclear duty rather than to individual error.

Interpreting Observed Patterns

Observed patterns, such as a rise in tagged bins during a particular week, are reported as observations and not as proof that a communication change caused the difference. The review team compares records across sites and weeks, notes plausible alternative explanations and states clearly where the evidence is too thin to support any conclusion about cause.

Review Questions for the Final Report

The final report must answer a fixed set of questions: whether the service ran as designed, where records were incomplete, which adjustments were needed and what residents asked about most often. It must also state what the pilot cannot tell us, particularly about long-term behaviour change. Recommendations are

separated from findings so that decision-makers can see the basis for each proposal.

Reporting Calendar and Responsibilities

Reporting follows a fixed calendar: weekly summaries during delivery, a mid-pilot checkpoint and a final report after the last collection. The coordinator owns the calendar, site leads supply site records and the review team drafts findings. Drafts are circulated for correction before publication, and the final report is presented to the sponsoring committee with the underlying register attached.